YIFAN JIANG

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https://yifanjiang-921.github.io/

Education Background

University of Southern California (USC) *Los Angeles,USA*
Ph.D. in Computer Science *08/2023~Current*
- Advisor: Dr. Jay Pujara

University of Southern California (USC) *Los Angeles,USA*
M.S. in Computer Science **Overall GPA:** 3.9/4.0 *01/2022~12/2023*
- Advisor: Dr. Filip Ilievski

Southern University of Science and Technology (SUSTech) *Shenzhen,China*
B.S. in Computer Science **Overall GPA:** 3.78/4.0 *09/2017~06/2021*
- Advisor: Dr. Xuan Song

University of California, Berkeley (UCB) *San Francisco,USA*
Exchange program in Computer Science **Overall GPA:** 4.0/4.0 *01/2020~05/2020*

Experience

Amazon Prime Video Seattle, USA
Research Intern *05/2026~Current*
Amazon Prime Video Seattle, USA
Research Intern *05/2025~08/2025*
Hippocratic AI *Palo Alto,USA*
Research Intern *05/2024~08/2024*
Information Sciences Institute, USC *Los Angeles,USA*
Research Assistant *05/2022~08/2023*

Selected Publication

- AFFORDANCE20Q: Evaluating Affordance Reasoning from Physical Properties
  Yifan Jiang, Meige Yang, Zitong Li, Jay Pujara
  [EMNLP 2026 Findings] Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, 2026.

- VIDEOP2R: Video Understanding from Perception to Reasoning
  Yifan Jiang, Yueying Wang, Rui Zhao, Toufiq Parag, Zhimin Chen, Zhenyu Liao, Jayakrishnan Unnikrishnan
  [CVPR 2026 Findings] The IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition, 2026.

- RED QUEEN: Safeguarding Large Language Models against Concealed Multi-Turn Jailbreaking
  Yifan Jiang, Kriti Aggarwal, Subhabrata Mukherjee, Tanmay Laud, Kashif Munir, Jay Pujara
  [ACL 2025 Findings] The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics

- MARVEL: Multidimensional Abstraction and Reasoning through Visual Evaluation and Learning
  Yifan Jiang*, Jiarui Zhang*, Kexuan Sun*, Zhivar Sourati, Kian Ahrabian, Kaixin Ma, Filip Ilievski, Jay Pujara
  [NeurIPS DB 2024] Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2024

- BRAINTEASER: Lateral Thinking Puzzles for Large Language Models
  Yifan Jiang, Filip Ilievski, Kaixin Ma, Zhivar Sourati
  [EMNLP 2023] Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, 2023.

- Transferring Procedural Knowledge across Commonsense Tasks
  Yifan Jiang, Kaixin Ma, Filip Ilievski
  [WNU@ACL 2023] ACL 2023 5th Workshop on Narrative Understanding.
  [ECAI 2023] European Conference on Artificial Intelligence, 2023.

- Semeval-2024 task 9: Brainteaser: A novel task defying common sense
  Yifan Jiang, Filip Ilievski, Kaixin Ma
  [SemEval@NAACL 2024] The 18th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation, 2024.

- Harbor Adapters and Harbor-Index: Infrastructure and a Curated Meta-Dataset for Large-Scale Agentic Evaluation
  [NeurIPS DB 2026] Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2026

- Engage for All: Making Ordinary Image Descriptions Appealing Again!
  Yuyan Chen, **Yifan Jiang**, Li Zhou, Jinghan Cao, Yu Guan, Ming Yang, Qingpei Guo
  [ICCV 2025] International Conference on Computer Vision, 2025.

- COLUMBUS: A Visual Question Answering Benchmark to Evaluate COgnitive Lateral Understanding through Multiple-choice reBUSes
  Koen Kraaijveld, **Yifan Jiang**, Kaixin Ma, Filip Ilievski
  [AAAI 2025] AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, 2025

- Recent Advances in Large Langauge Model Benchmarks against Data Contamination: From Static to Dynamic Evaluation
  Simin Chen, Yiming Chen, Zexin Li, **Yifan Jiang**, Zhongwei Wan, Yixin He, Dezhi Ran, Tianle Gu, Haizhou Li, Tao Xie, Baishakhi Ray
  [EMNLP 2025]

- Srpo: Enhancing multimodal llm reasoning via reflection-aware reinforcement learning
  Zhongwei Wan, Zhihao Dou, Che Liu, Yu Zhang, Dongfei Cui, Qinjian Zhao, Hui Shen, Jing Xiong, Yi Xin, **Yifan Jiang**, Chaofan Tao, Yangfan He, Mi Zhang, Shen Yan
  [NeurIPS 2025] Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2025

- The curious case of nonverbal abstract reasoning with multi-modal large language models
  Kian Ahrabian*, Zhivar Sourati*, Kexuan Sun*, Jiarui Zhang, **Yifan Jiang,** Fred Morstatter, Jay Pujara
  [COLM 2024] Conference On Language Modeling, 2024

- ARN: Analogical Reasoning on Narratives
  Zhivar Sourati, Filip Ilievski, Pia Sommerauer, **Yifan Jiang**
  [TACL 2024] Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics, 2024.

- FIRE: Food Image to REcipe generation
  Prateek Chhikara, Dhiraj Chaurasia, **Yifan Jiang**, Omkar Masur
  [WACV 2024] IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision, 2024.

- TrafPS: A Shapley-based Visual Analytics Approach to Interpret Traffic
  Zezheng Feng, **Yifan Jiang**, Hongjun Wang, Zipei Fan, Yuxin Ma, Shuang-Hua Yang, Huamin Qu, Xuan Song
  [CVMJ 2023] Computational Visual Media Journal, 2023.

Service

- Area Chair: EMNLP (2026)
- Reviewer: NeurIPS (2025, 2026), CVPR (2026), ECCV (2026), ICLR (2025), ACL (2025), EMNLP (2025), COLING (2025), LREC (2026), LREC-COLING (2024), SemEval (2024), IEEE SSCI (2025), Neurosymbolic AI (2026), Analogy-ANGLE Workshop (2024, 2025)

Honors

- Computer Science Honor Program, University of Southern California, 2022
- ISI Distinguished Graduate Student Researcher Fellowship Award, University of Southern California, 2023